



Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

## CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



### Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Blimey! The screen blinked and turned black. Can you hear this annoying bleep?



## Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

## Can Do Statements

- I can say and use the sound *bl*.
- I can stress questions with sentences.
- I can stress new information.

## Ask your partner:

- Are you good with computers and electronic devices?
- If you have a technical issue, do you call a technician for help? Why or why not?
- Do you like to share your electronic devices? Why or why not?





## Let's Explore!

Oh no! It's **the blue screen of death**\*! Who's to blame for this **blunder**\*\*?

\* This is an informal way of referring to error messages on Windows computers.

\*\* A "blunder" is a mistake.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

- Vanessa:** Blimey! My computer is not working! I bought it last month!
- Peter:** It's probably nothing serious. Maybe I'll be able to fix it for you.
- Vanessa:** How much do you know about computer repair?
- Peter:** I had to fix mine recently. I kept getting the blue screen of death.
- Vanessa:** Oh, I hate when that happens.
- Peter:** Can I see what kind of error message you are getting?
- Vanessa:** I don't even have a message! The screen keeps blinking and then turns black. All I hear is this annoying bleep!
- Peter:** When do you remember having this problem for the first time?
- Vanessa:** I'm not sure. I blame that tech guy! I'm so disappointed right now!
- Peter:** I think technology makes you irritable. Here, take my computer for now.
- Vanessa:** Are you sure you don't you need it for work?
- Peter:** I'll use my desktop at the office. This is my personal laptop. You're welcome to borrow it if you want.
- Vanessa:** Thanks, Peter. You're such a nice bloke!
- Peter:** Aw, you're going to make me blush now! That's what friends are for.



## Let's Practice!

Time to pronounce the **bl** sound.

*Instructions: Organize the mystery words. Read the words aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

1. yieblm

\_\_\_\_\_

4. lmbe

\_\_\_\_\_

2. ilnkb

\_\_\_\_\_

5. hsbul

\_\_\_\_\_

3. epbel

\_\_\_\_\_



## Let's Practice!

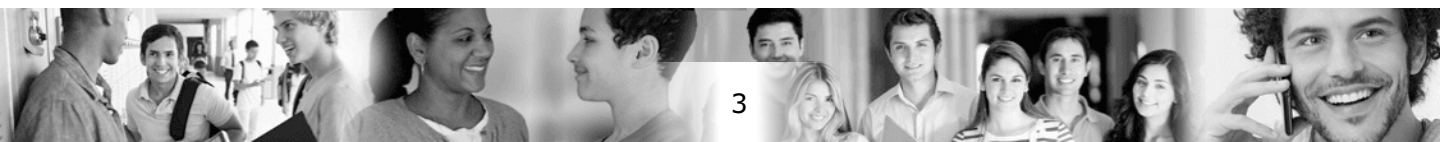
Vanessa is stressed about her new computer!

*Instructions: Read the paragraph. Complete the paragraph with the correct words. Use words from the word bank below.*

### Word Bank

- screen
- message
- have
- hate
- not
- month
- blinking
- so
- tech
- computer
- bought
- happens
- black
- not

My \_\_\_\_\_ is \_\_\_\_\_ working. I \_\_\_\_\_ it last \_\_\_\_\_! I \_\_\_\_\_ when that \_\_\_\_\_ . The \_\_\_\_\_ kept \_\_\_\_\_ and then went \_\_\_\_\_. I don't even \_\_\_\_\_ an error \_\_\_\_\_! I blame that \_\_\_\_\_ guy! I'm \_\_\_\_\_ disappointed right now!





## Extension Activity

Write a dialogue about a technical problem.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Write a dialogue (12-14 lines) with a partner.
- Think of a technical problem with an electronic device.
- Give information on the problem. Stress the new information.
- Ask for clarification. Stress the correct words in the questions.
- Use at least 5 words with the *bl* sound.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I use words with the *bl* sound.

☐ ☐

I stress new information.

☐ ☐

I stress information in questions with sentences.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **blimey** (expression): a British English expression used to show surprise or alarm  
e.g. Blimey! My computer is not working.
- **error message** (noun): a message displayed on a screen that shows that there is a fault in a device  
e.g. What kind of error message are you getting?
- **to blink** (verb): to emit light intermittently  
e.g. The screen keeps blinking.
- **bleep** (noun): a short high-pitched electronic sound  
e.g. All I hear is this annoying bleep!
- **to blush** (verb): to become pink in the face from embarrassment or compliments  
e.g. You're going to make me blush now!
- **to blame** (verb): to assign responsibility for a fault  
e.g. I blame that tech guy!
- **bloke** (noun): a British English term for a young man  
e.g. Thanks, Peter. You're such a nice bloke.
- **irritable** (adjective): having a tendency to be easily annoyed  
e.g. I think technology makes you irritable.
- **disappointed** (adjective): displeased because of someone or something  
e.g. My computer is not working. I'm so disappointed right now!





## Learning Points

### Consonant Blends Bl Sound

Consonant clusters like *bl* can occur at the beginning of a word in English.

Practice blending the sound from one consonant sound into the next without adding a vowel sound in between.

Read the following words aloud.

Examples:

|               |              |              |              |
|---------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|
| <i>blimey</i> | <i>bloke</i> | <i>blink</i> | <i>bleep</i> |
| <i>blush</i>  | <i>blame</i> | <i>blue</i>  | <i>black</i> |

In addition, the consonant cluster *bl* can be found at the end of a word, like *able*, *irritable* or *probable*.

Notice how the sound changes by adding the vowel sound (/ə/)

#### Examples:

- **Ann:** *The screen keeps blinking and then turns black.*
- **Bob:** *Technology makes you irritable.*





## Learning Points

### Stressing New Information in Questions With Sentences

When you want to stress new information, you use different intonation and stress on the "new" idea. You can stress questions with sentences in the same way.

You usually stress content words in a sentence. Content words are the words that carry the most meaning (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, etc.).

When you want to introduce new information in a conversation, you can choose to put the stress and the intonation on the "new" idea. This helps the listener understand that you want to stress that word and that it is important.

*Example:*

**Sally:** *I'm having problems with my computer.*

**Peter:** What **kind** of problems?

Sentence stress gives English its **rhythm** or **beat**.

Word stress is emphasis on **one syllable** within a **word**.

Sentence stress is emphasis on **certain words** within a **sentence**.

Most sentences have two basic types of words:

#### **content words**

- Content words are the important or key words in a sentence. They provide the meaning of the sentence.

#### **structure words**

- Structure words are not important words. They are small words that you use to make the sentence correct.

When you stress these "new" words, your voice will rise slightly (intonation).

Notice the stress in the following questions with sentences:

Can I **see** what **kind** of error you are **getting**?

How **much** do you **know** about **computer** repair?

**When** do you remember **having** this problem for the **first** time?

Blimey! My **computer** is **not** working! I **bought** it last **month**!

